Aheadly

CLARITY TODAY. A BRIGHTER TOMORROW.

APP PROJECT OVERVIEW · MILESTONE I

AI-powered financial planning for small businesses

Turning the data a business already has into clear, forward-looking cash decisions.



TEAM

[Team name]

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PROJECT SUMMARY · PROBLEM & TARGET USER

Small business owners are forced to guess

Who

Owners of small, local businesses in Colombia (bakeries, cafés, shops) with 1 to 15 employees and no finance staff.

The problem

They can't see a cash shortfall coming, so payroll, supplier bills and big purchases are decided blind.

Why it matters

One surprise shortfall means a late supplier, an overdraft fee or a missed payroll.



HOW THEY COPE TODAY

Bank balance
Shows today, not next month

Spreadsheets
Only show what already happened

Gut feel
Plus an accountant once a month

PROJECT SUMMARY · SOLUTION & ROLE OF AI

A financial co-pilot that sees what's next

Aheadly connects to the business's bank and QuickBooks, forecasts cash for the next 8 weeks, warns early in plain words and answers what-if questions.

AI JOB	KIND OF AI	WHY AI, AND NOT A FIXED RULE
Forecast cash flow Runs daily in the background	**Time-series ML model** Prophet (Python), trained on her own transactions	Learns each business's seasonality, weekly rhythm and recurring bills. A fixed spreadsheet rule can't adapt to every business.
Write plain alerts When a shortfall or idle cash is coming	**LLM API** Claude or Gemini	Turns forecast numbers into a short message with the cause and 2 to 3 actions. A template can't explain the why for each case.
Answer & run what-ifs In a simple chat, in her own words	**LLM + function calling** Claude or Gemini calls our forecast engine	Turns "What if I buy the oven next month?" into scenario inputs and reruns the forecast. No finance skills or menus needed.

Guardrail: every number comes from the forecast engine. The LLM only explains and translates, so it never invents figures.

PROJECT SUMMARY · MVP SCOPE

Four core features, nothing more

1

Connect financial accounts

Link the bank (Plaid sandbox) and QuickBooks once. Transactions then sync on their own.

2

Receive early-warning alert

The forecast runs daily. A plain-language alert arrives when a shortfall or idle cash is coming.

3

Ask about my numbers

Chat with Aheadly about balances, trends and upcoming bills, in everyday words.

4

Test a what-if scenario

Model a purchase or change before deciding, with best, base and worst case.

OUT OF SCOPE FOR NOW

- ✕ Moving money or paying bills
- ✕ Bookkeeping, invoicing and taxes
- ✕ Loans or credit offers
- ✕ Native mobile app (MVP is a Streamlit web app)
- ✕ Multiple users or accountant access
- ✕ Live Colombian bank feeds (MVP uses Plaid sandbox data)

Stack: Python, Streamlit, SQLite, Prophet, Plaid, QuickBooks API, Claude or Gemini API

STORYBOARD · PERSONA

Meet Maria, the owner we design for

Maria Gómez, 45

Owner of Panadería La Esquina, Bogotá

Opened her neighborhood bakery 12 years ago. 6 employees, walk-in customers and two cafés she supplies.

Goals

- Never miss payroll or a supplier bill
- Know if she can afford a new oven
- Worry less about the numbers

Pain points

- Only sees today's bank balance
- Accountant's report arrives a month late
- Bills pile up in one week and surprise her

Tech comfort: medium

- Daily: smartphone, WhatsApp, online banking
- QuickBooks set up by her accountant
- Won't learn a complex finance tool



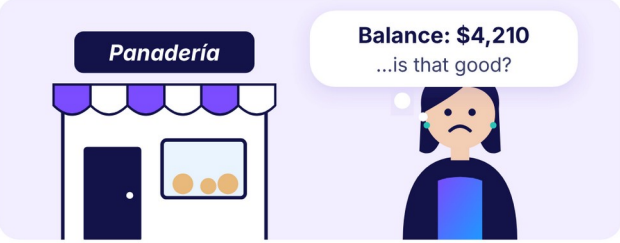
"I know how to bake. I just need to know if I'll have enough cash next month."

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STORYBOARD · MAIN FLOW

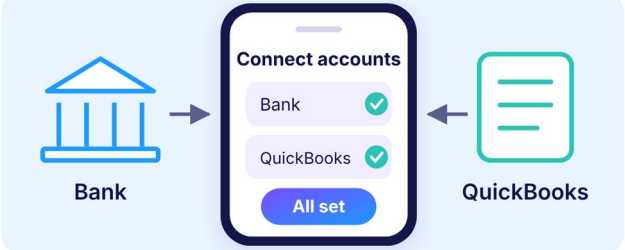
How Maria avoids a cash crunch

1 Guessing



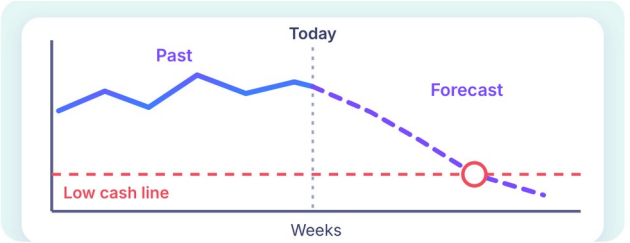
Maria runs a small bakery. She checks her bank balance to guess how things are going, and hopes for the best.

2 Connect once



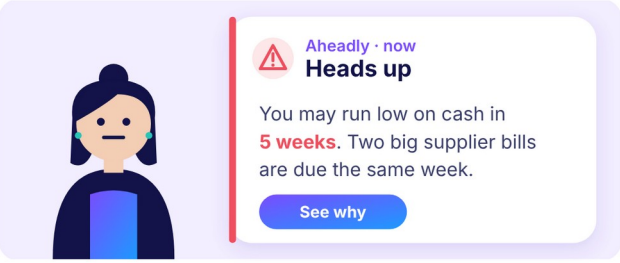
She links her bank and QuickBooks to Aheadly. It only takes a few minutes.

3 Always watching



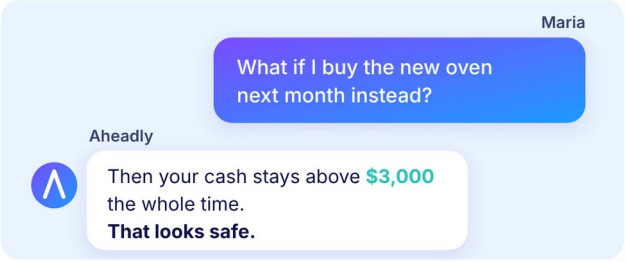
Every day Aheadly checks her money and predicts the next few weeks. Maria doesn't have to do anything.

4 Early warning



Weeks before trouble hits, she gets a simple alert in plain words, with no finance terms.

5 Ask in plain words



She asks a follow-up question and tests a "what-if" before deciding, just like texting a friend.

6 Act with confidence



Maria waits on the oven. No surprise overdraft, and she understands why. Guessing becomes planning.

UML · USE CASE DIAGRAM

Four goals, one primary actor

Primary actor

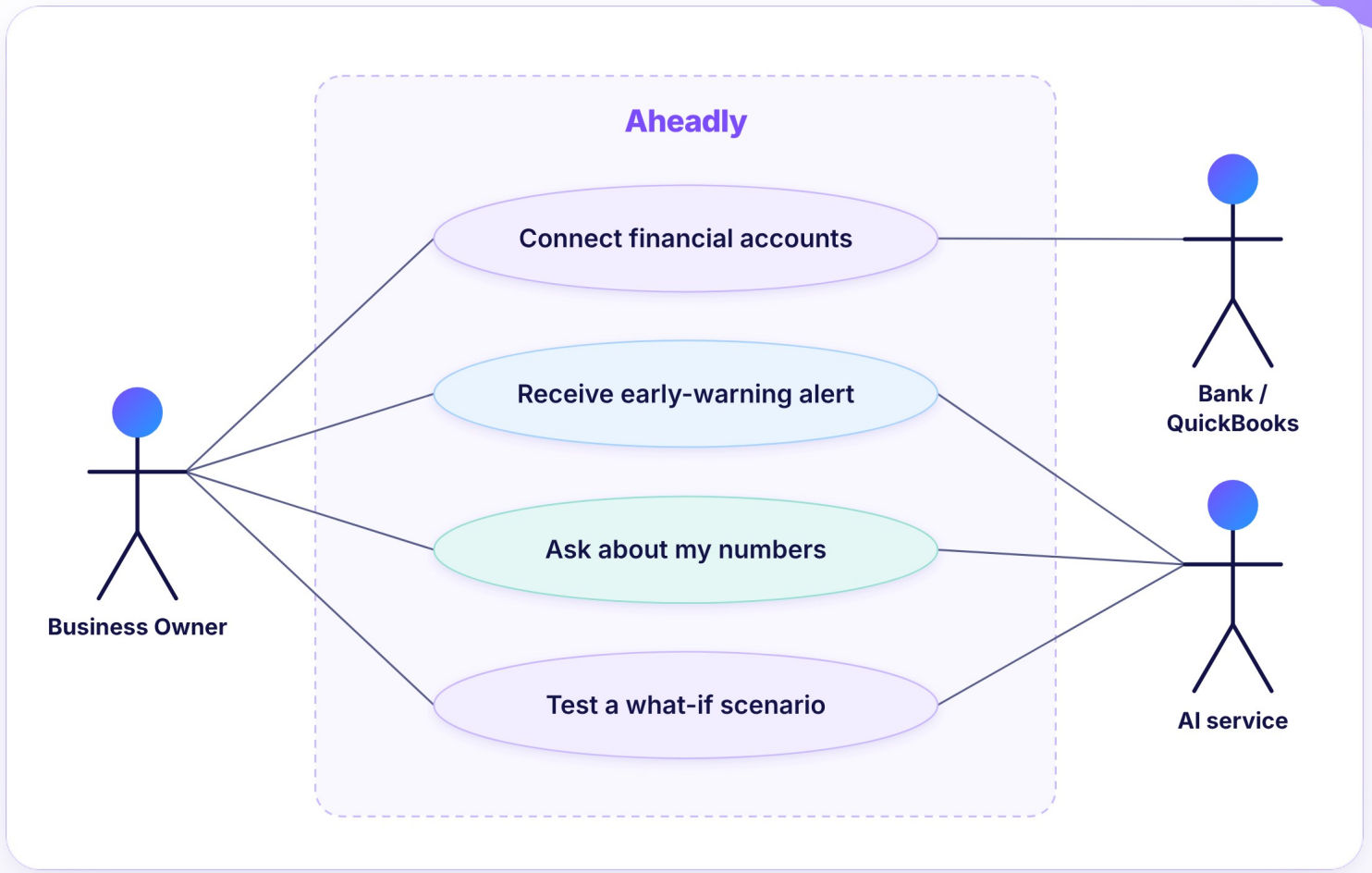
Business Owner: our persona Maria.

Secondary actors

Bank / QuickBooks for data, and an external AI service (Claude or Gemini LLM API).

Use cases = MVP

Each of the 4 MVP features is one goal-named use case inside the Aheadly boundary.



UML · COMPONENT DIAGRAM

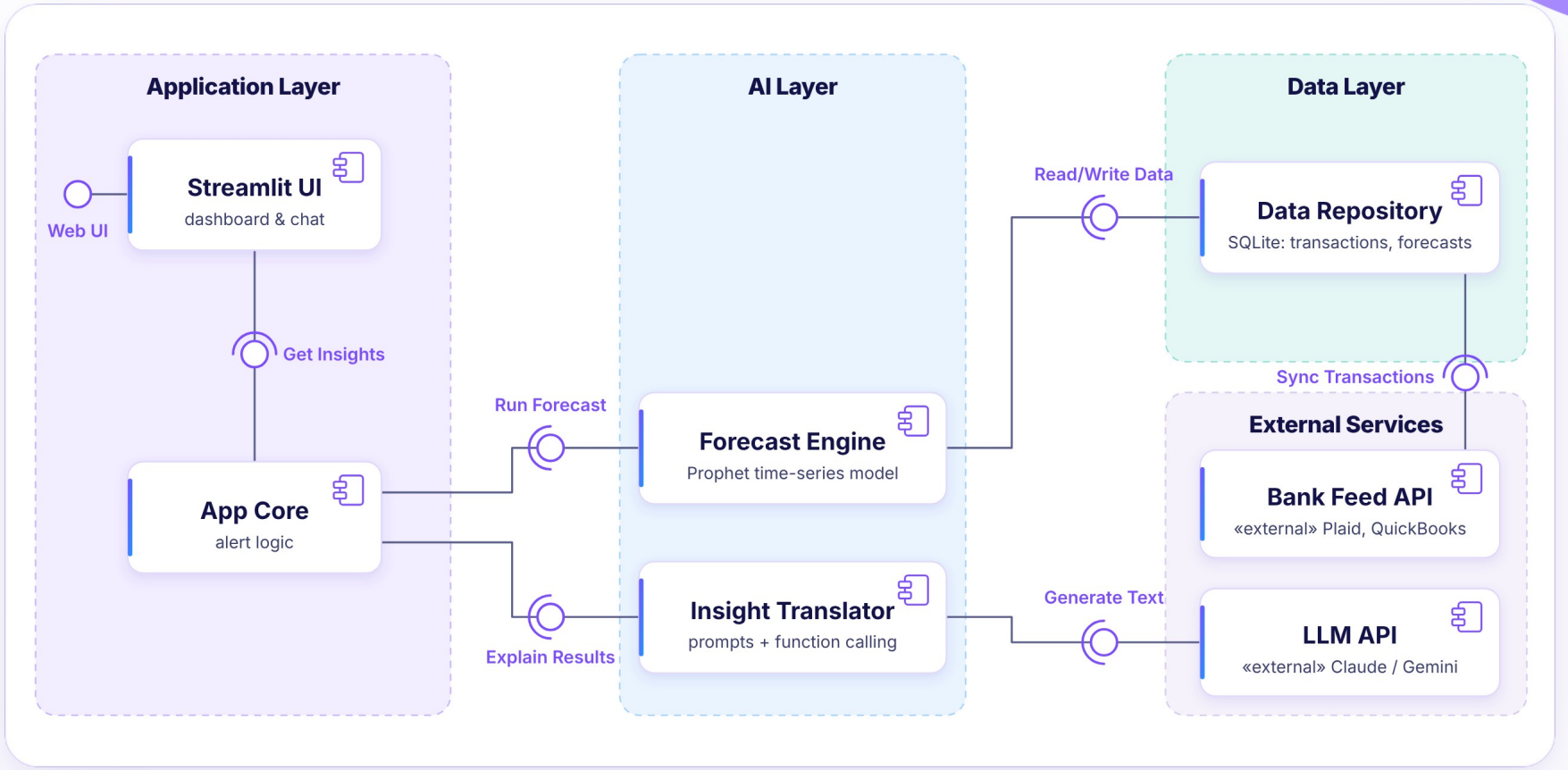
Three layers, two external services

Application
Streamlit UI and the App Core alert logic

AI
Prophet forecasts, an LLM explains them

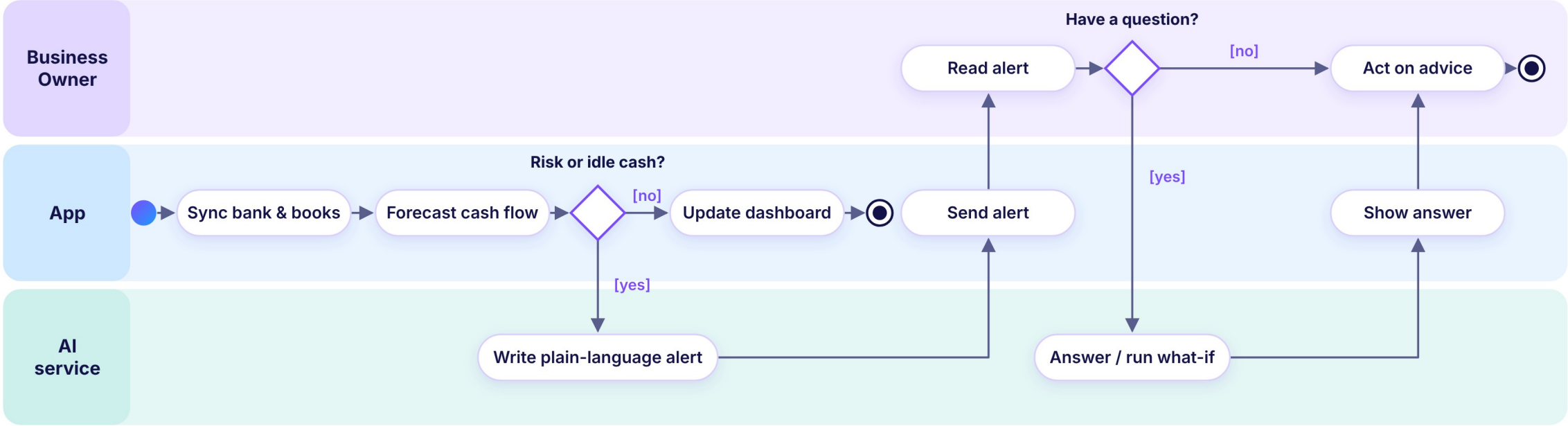
Data
SQLite store fed by Plaid and QuickBooks

«external» = services we call, not build. Ball = provided interface, socket = required.



UML · ACTIVITY DIAGRAM

Core flow: from data to decision



Start
A daily sync of bank and books starts each run.

AI steps
Alert writing and what-if answers have their own swimlane.

Decisions
Two labeled decisions. Every path ends at a final node.

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CONSISTENCY ACROSS DELIVERABLES

One product, one story

Maria
Target user in the summary = persona = primary actor in the use case diagram

4 MVP features
The same 4 goals appear as the 4 use cases

Storyboard frames 3 to 6
The activity diagram: forecast, alert, question, decision

Plaid, QuickBooks, Claude, Gemini
The «external» services in the component diagram



Clarity today. A brighter tomorrow.